



Asteroid deflection mission

To prevent any impending killer asteroids, scientists are looking towards "Armageddon" style asteroid mission. <http://digit.in/AstrdLndng>



Heart attack from bite

A 45 year old man suffered an allergic reaction and then a heart attack after being bitten by a wasp. <http://digit.in/WaspAttck>

Intel Core i7 7740X

An interesting turn of events

Intel's Basin Falls platform had quite a few surprises in store. There

were two additions to the processor family, i.e. the Intel Core i7-7740X and the Intel Core i5-7640X which stood out from the rest. These were Kabylake-X CPUs that were built for the X299 platform. And they hardly had anything to do with the benefits of the X299 platform except for the higher TDP and support for higher memory frequency.

We start off with Cinebench R15 and Kabylake-X immediately shines through ahead of every other SKU we've tested. Its score is better than even the newly released 10-core Core i9 7900X as well making it the best performing Intel SKU in this particular benchmark. Moving on to the multi-threaded run of Cinebench R15, we see that the 7740X is ahead of the 7700K by a sliver but every other CPU with more threads easily scores much better than the 7740X.

The 7740X is a unique proposition from Intel. It has exhibited some of the best single-threaded performance we've seen with the Kabylake microarchitecture. However, the 7700K along with a Z270 board seems to offer near about the same performance for a much lower investment. This is because of the fact that the X299 boards are not at all cheap. And even if you did invest in an X299 board, then the Kabylake-X CPUs can't make the most of the platform because of the lower PCIe lane count. However, they overclock really well. We've seen HWBOT entries of 7.5 GHz which is no feeble feat. With Coffee Lake-S on the horizon, it'd be better to wait and see how that pans out before getting a 7740X.

—Mithun Mohandas



Price
₹26,300



PERFORMANCE.....78
VALUE.....75

SPECIFICATIONS

CLOCK SPEED: 4.3 GHz | TURBO FREQUENCY: 4.5 GHz | CORES/THREADS: 4/8 | SCALABILITY: 15 Only | LITHOGRAPHY: 14nm | TDP: 112W | PCIe LANES: 16 | PCIe VERSION: 3.0 | MEMORY SUPPORT: DDR4.

CONTACT

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Micromax Canvas Infinity

Pretty but flawed

The phone features an edge-to-edge display with an aspect ratio of 18:9, similar to LG Q6. While the IPS LCD is bright enough for all kinds of lighting conditions, the 1440 x 720p resolution does look a little stretched out.

The UI on the other hand is a total disaster in our books. Instead of using the simpler stock interface, we have a custom skin running on top of Android 7.1.2 Nougat. It is ridiculously buggy and makes the phone freeze from time to time. All pre-installed apps ask for critical permissions to manage your phone calls, contacts, etc.

While the back is made of metal, it is actually just a metal plate on top of a plastic holder, and the entire rear housing can be removed to reveal a removable battery. From a fair bit use, we think that Micromax has done a good enough job and the phone seems sturdy.

The older Qualcomm Snapdragon 425 SoC seems out of place in the budget segment in 2017. The 2900 mAh battery, 720p screen resolution and a not so powerful SoC, combine to provide a day's worth of battery life.

The 13MP rear camera on the device is one of the best we have seen in this category. It captures decent details and the colour saturation is almost accurate.

The Micromax Canvas Infinity is a good smartphone, marred only by a frustrating UI. The phone has the looks, offers good battery life, stable gaming performance and the two cameras are most likely the best set of shooters you would find in the sub-10K category.

—Hardik Singh



Price
₹9,999



FEATURE.....74
PERFORMANCE.....54
VALUE.....65
DESIGN.....68

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 425 | GPU: Adreno 308 | OS: Android 7.1.2 | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 128 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: IPS Panel | SIZE: 5.7 inches | RESOLUTION: 720 x 1440 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: 13 MP, f/2.0 | CAMERA SECONDARY: 16 MP, f/2.0

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